



"Vybe Together" Removed

Apple pulls iPhone app promoting secret indoor house parties during the pandemic, used TikTok to market. <http://digit.in/jan21-63>



AI-based Dumpster Cameras

Compology's monitoring system takes numerous images to analyze and determine how full a container is. <http://digit.in/jan21-64>

sought after and highly popular crafts or regions. We remain committed to being a platform by the artisans, for the dying crafts and dedicated to the artisanal traditions of the Himalayas. At the heart of Ladakh Local, lies an undeterred determination to eliminate the third-party and middlemen involved in the distribution and supply chain." The focus is very much on making dying art, which is replaced by machines and mass production, a viable economic endeavour again. "Each of our offerings is not an impersonal object, but a story of the craft, the maker and the tradition of its place of origin. In our humble capacities, we aim to make our dream a reality of revitalising the traditional sector of Ladakh and bring its long hidden aesthetic treasures to the world and the connoisseurs of fine art. Apart from this, Ladakh Local would be the only e-commerce company involved in the revival of Pottery, Metal work and other Ladakhi handicrafts with a focused approach to not only facilitate trade and supply chain but also going concern and sustainability."

We then asked about the benefit to the artisans who get on to the platform, "Under the brand of Ladakh Local, artisans would be made the craft champions leading to recognition. We intend to bring recognition and make them the face of metal work and pottery in Ladakh at a global level. They would get help with standardization in practicing the craft along with design and development to further hone the craft. The craft would get documented along with their stories. Currently the artisans struggle with logistics, packaging and online payment systems. Ladakh Local intends to bridge the knowledge gap."

Ladakh Local also hopes to use technology to the fullest extent, and explains the role of tech in their plans, "technology is being used not only to build a brand on social media and other digital platforms to reach the targeted audience. Technology itself would be used to revive the craft form through resource mobilisation that

have eluded the region and the craft. Documentation of the craft, training the artisans and the region to be more accepting of digital modes of payment, a reach on social media, and an e-commerce platform for people to access the handicrafts from any part of the world would be a good push in the right direction."

PAHADIZAIIKA SELLS HIMALAYAN FARM PRODUCE

PahdiZaika is a farm to kitchen ecommerce platform that provides authentic details of sourcing, and deals only in unprocessed farm produce. The niche operator hopes to provide abundant information, minimise travel time and costs, and maximise the options available to



Almonds from Kinnaur, on sale on PahadiZaika

the consumer. One of the interesting problems faced by PahadiZaika is that they have to advocate the consumption of healthy foodstuff in Indian markets, whereas the demand for the produce is considerably more in the international market. For this reason, the produce may be available to people outside the country, even though it is grown in the Himalayas. We asked PahadiZaika to explain to us how most of the produce makes it to international markets, "The volume of the Indian organic market for 2019 was around USD 850 million. For the same year, if we see the size of the US industry was USD 46 billion (data is taken from www.foodbusinessnews.net). The Indian organic market is growing at a very good rate, but the demand for organic

food items on the foreign market is very strong. The sole focus is therefore on more and more exports of organic goods. India's export is second only to China." Aggravating the situation is the local attitudes towards what is considered as healthy eating, "For a country like India that has been used to a diet filled with flavour and dipped in oil and ghee vats, the urge to consume safe and organic food has been very incremental. The root of this dilemma can be traced back to the notion that eating healthy meant giving up all that tastes good and sticking to a tight diet of soft salads and vegetables. That said the understanding of nutritious and organic food has grown over the last few years. It will gradually increase."

When we probed about the tech used, PahadiZaika shared with us that they used a combination of WordPress and WooCommerce. "We are using LAMP Stack, on top of it we have used WordPress with WooCommerce. Currently, we are doing 100% In-House WordPress Development. We are using WordPress with WooCommerce

because as we are bootstrapping, this medium is free. It's free and it offers order tracking, update delivery statuses, view past and open orders, apply discounts, adjust tax settings, manage inventory, adjust shipping options. It offers everything that an eCommerce store needs." We followed up by asking the suitability of WordPress and WooCommerce for the platform, "WordPress is designed with security in mind and is a reliable platform for running a website. WooCommerce is very flexible because hundreds of free and paid plugins are available to add additional WooCommerce store features. These extensions include accounting-related software and payment gateways, marketing, reporting, and much more."